

RESEARCH AND RECOMMENDATIONS

Aksen Labs positioning and market strategy

Prepared for the Aksen Labs founder | Ghana base, African mission, cross-border opportunities

Aksen Labs should be positioned as a digital transformation agency helping African businesses grow through technology. Its work can span customer experience, commerce, business operations, data and new digital products. AI strengthens that work wherever it improves the result.

The founder's ambition has three distinct levels. The mission is African business prosperity. The agency helps a particular business improve how it earns revenue and operates. Individual solutions and future products address specific jobs. Keeping these levels clear gives Aksen room to grow while making each engagement understandable.

Recommended company description: Aksen Labs is a digital transformation agency helping African businesses grow, serve customers better and run more effectively. We design and build websites, business systems and digital products, connect the tools teams rely on, and apply AI where it makes the work more useful. We work with clients from understanding the problem through implementation, team adoption and improvement.

Recommended public promise: Technology that helps your business grow.

Mission: Help African businesses prosper through the effective use of technology.

Geographic line: Based in Ghana. Built for African ambition. Open to businesses wherever we can deliver useful results.

Use the mission in the company story and the public promise in the opening sales message. Explain prosperity through observable improvements: more profitable business, dependable service, stronger operations and better decisions. Avoid implying that technology guarantees these outcomes.

The scope is full digital transformation, delivered through defined engagements. A small website project can be a valid engagement; so can a connected commerce and operations system. Discovery should decide the appropriate scale. Every prospective client should be able to recognize a concrete starting point.

What changes from earlier strategy: retain Aksen Labs; replace workflow-only company positioning; keep Ghana as a base and practical acquisition focus; treat Nigerian and other qualified opportunities as normal business. Narrow campaigns remain useful for learning. They do not redefine the entire agency.

Evidence basis: founder direction, local source review and the global/African comparisons on the following pages. The wording is a recommendation. This research does not establish completed Aksen client transformations or a continent-wide operating footprint.

POSITIONING NOTE 02

Where the current messaging narrows the business

The current public source consistently teaches visitors to associate Aksen with AI workflows. The TFS proposal offers a broader business intervention. Changing only the headline would leave that contradiction in navigation, discovery and the website guide.

Surface reviewed	Current signal	Recommended correction
Homepage and metadata	Practical AI workflows; industry hero examples start with enquiries	State the agency category and business promise first; show complete business journeys below
Navigation and primary action	Agents appears first; Find your first workflow	Lead with Services and Approach; use Discuss your business as the main action
Solutions page	Repetitive tasks, replies, content drafts and information retrieval	Show commerce/customer experience, operations, insight and digital product development
Opportunity Mapper	Choices mainly describe existing workflow frustration	Also admit new websites, online sales, disconnected systems, expansion and new products
Aksen Guide	System prompt and fallbacks recommend agents and one workflow	Give the guide the broader agency description and route by business need
TFS proposal	Storefront, projects, payments, admin, AI, reporting and training	Use this breadth to explain the transformation approach, with proposal status explicit

The existing site has strengths to preserve: understandable examples, clear staff responsibility, discovery before commitment, training and measured progress. Its footer already gestures beyond Ghana. The problem is the repeated narrowing of the service category throughout the main journey.

The September 4 launch report explicitly recommended workflow implementation and managed operations as the company identity, with broader work in supporting roles. The September 5 product review carried that framing forward. The founder's September 7 instruction replaces that positioning direction. Those reports remain historical research rather than the current messaging authority.

Source files reviewed: platform/app/page.tsx; platform/app/layout.tsx; platform/app/solutions/page.tsx; platform/components/site-chrome.tsx; platform/components/standalone-mapper.tsx; platform/components/aksen-guide.tsx; platform/app/api/chat/route.ts; platform/app/api/recommendation/route.ts; research/launch-strategy-2026-09-04/report-source.md; research/product-review-2026-09-05/report-source.md; build_blueprint.py; clients/opes-tfs/client-proposal-ope.md and associated discovery/pricing notes. Source inspection establishes the local messaging, not the state of the deployed website.

POSITIONING NOTE 03

What the global comparisons show

Large consultancies and agencies commonly combine a broad business promise with focused services and proprietary products. This establishes a viable positioning pattern, not proof that copying their language will win Aksen customers.

Business	Observed structure	Lesson for Aksen
Thoughtworks	Technology consultancy with AI/works, engineering, transformation pathways and managed services	A product can sit inside a broader capability story
Publicis Sapient	Enterprise AI solutions supported by experts and platforms such as Slingshot and Bodhi	Describe the business problems that connected technology addresses
BCG X	Design and technology delivery, customer experience, platforms and new ventures, with a product library	A parent brand can own transformation relationships and multiple products
DEPT	Growth-oriented offer across marketing, customer experience, commerce, technology/data and AI; Deptify is a named offering	Group breadth around business needs rather than a long list of tools

Sources: [Thoughtworks homepage](#), [Publicis Sapient homepage](#), [BCG X overview and product library](#), [DEPT homepage](#). Publisher: each named company. Undated live pages, checked 7 September 2026. Descriptions reflect published offers, not independently tested performance.

Some current global homepages lead heavily with AI. That is a useful counterpoint: there is no universal rule that a broad agency must hide the technology. Aksen's problem is that the current AI framing makes its wider offer hard to discover. Its young brand needs more explicit explanation than a widely known consultancy.

McKinsey's August 2026 survey reports that 80% of respondents experienced individual productivity improvement from AI, while 37% attributed some enterprise earnings impact to it. Higher performers more often reported workflow redesign and growth ambitions. The survey covered 1,719 respondents in 97 nations, with fieldwork in May-June 2026. These are self-reported associations, not causal proof or a Ghanaian small-business sample.

Source: [McKinsey Global Survey, The state of AI in 2026](#), 25 August 2026; checked 7 September 2026.

Implication: Aksen's value should include business diagnosis, implementation, adoption and measurement. Making software easier to build increases the importance of choosing and implementing the right change. AI can contribute to growth and new offerings as well as administrative efficiency.

POSITIONING NOTE 04

What the African comparisons add

The Arkesel product is KOVA IQ. Its published offer is a messaging-first CRM with customer records, AI assistance, tickets, campaigns and light commerce. Arkesel is the parent communications platform; KOVA IQ has a distinct buyer problem and product identity. VoiceConnect is another named product. This is a useful brand architecture comparison; Arkesel itself is not presented here as a full transformation agency.

Sources: [Arkesel](#), [KOVA IQ](#) and [VoiceConnect](#). Publisher: Arkesel. Undated live pages, checked 7 September 2026. Advertised capabilities were not functionally tested.

Comparator	Published structure	Relevant interpretation
CWG and Fifthlab	Fifthlab combines digital strategy, design, software and analytics with products including SMERP, FinEdge and BillsNPay	The closest researched African example of consulting capabilities alongside products
Rancard	Named products organized beneath an AI customer-engagement business, with industry solutions	Products become easier to understand when they share a coherent domain
Hubtel	An Africa-level company mission alongside a Ghana-focused business offer	Ambition and current market focus can be communicated at different levels

Sources: [CWG Fifthlab](#), [Rancard products](#), [Hubtel business homepage](#) and [Hubtel mission](#). Publisher: each named company. Undated live pages, checked 7 September 2026. These are positioning observations, not comparisons of revenue, profitability or customer satisfaction.

For Aksen, retain one recognizable parent brand. Describe agency capabilities directly under Aksen Labs. When a recurring problem becomes an independently supportable product, it can carry its own name with an endorsement such as "by Aksen Labs". An additional holding-company or studio brand would add complexity without solving a demonstrated need today.

These firms also illustrate a competitive reality: clients may already be able to buy a useful system. Aksen should be comfortable assessing, configuring and connecting existing software when that best serves the client. Custom building earns its place when the required business fit or integration justifies it. This is a delivery recommendation, not a procurement endorsement of any researched vendor.

POSITIONING NOTE 05

Bringing the research into Ghana and Nigeria

The local opportunity is to help businesses make productive use of technology. IFC's 2024 research describes incomplete digitalization: access to tools does not necessarily become intensive use across business functions. This supports an offer that includes implementation and adoption. It does not establish how many firms can afford Aksen's services.

Source: [IFC, Digital Opportunities in African Businesses](#), 2024, and [IFC release](#), 16 May 2024; checked 7 September 2026. Regional evidence, not a 2026 country-specific market census.

IFC's 2023 analysis covered 3,325 microenterprises across seven countries, including Ghana and Nigeria. Costs, skills and perceived lack of need were barriers to adoption. Its authors distinguish performance associations from causation. These pooled findings should inform discovery questions, not assumptions about every established business.

Source: [IFC, Digital Technologies Are a Useful Yet Underutilized Tool for African Microenterprises](#), 2023; checked 7 September 2026. Underlying fieldwork predates publication; many sampled firms were very small and informal.

Ghana-specific World Bank analysis recommends foundational technology adoption and skills as the base for more advanced AI and automation. Its 2021 publication is historical structural evidence, not a current readiness estimate. For Aksen, the practical lesson is to assess records, responsibilities and staff use before promising AI improvements.

Source: [World Bank, Technological transformation of Ghanaian MSMEs](#), 24 November 2021; checked 7 September 2026.

Recommended market approach: operate from Ghana, pursue accessible Ghanaian prospects and qualified Nigerian opportunities such as TFS, then expand based on evidence and delivery capacity. A country is neither an automatic qualification nor a disqualification.

Localize each engagement's currency, payment arrangements, buying process, customer channels, delivery commitments, support hours and third-party dependencies. Establish these from the actual business. The Nigerian proposal is useful evidence that Aksen already contemplates cross-border work; it does not establish a Nigerian operating footprint or a validated market segment.

No current Ghana or Nigeria willingness-to-pay estimate was established. Initial segment selection should therefore follow reachable buyers with a costly problem, an accountable owner, usable information and a budget compatible with delivery.

POSITIONING NOTE 06

TFS shows what the agency relationship means

The current TFS proposal describes a connected digital platform for retail purchases and bespoke project enquiries. The intended business change spans the customer journey and the team's daily work. That is a concrete way to explain Aksen's broader offer.

Proposed component	Business purpose	Candidate measure
Shared storefront and catalogue	Help customers understand frames, art and decor and choose an item	Qualified enquiries and purchase conversion
Projects portfolio and enquiry capture	Give bespoke work a clear route from interest to assessment	Complete project briefs and quote turnaround
Checkout and payment confirmation	Connect an order with verified payment status	Paid-order completion and reconciliation time
Dashboard and business records	Let staff maintain information and track work	Record completeness and staff usage
Customer and internal AI assistance	Help customers and staff use approved information	Helpful responses, corrections and handover quality
Training and reporting	Support daily adoption and improvement	Time per task and tracked follow-up completion

A suitable description of the proposal: For The Frame Shop, Aksen has proposed a connected commerce and operations system that brings product discovery, online orders, project enquiries and team tools together. AI supports customers and staff using the same approved business information.

This is proposal wording. Do not present TFS as a successful case study, accepted engagement or completed system without confirmation. The folder README still describes pre-discovery status, and reviewed files do not establish acceptance, payment or delivered outcomes.

The earlier discovery brief argued for a catalogue with WhatsApp handoff and no checkout. The current proposal explicitly includes checkout. The pricing guide contains older package amounts, while the proposal states NGN 250,000 implementation and NGN 30,000 monthly AI subscriptions. Use the proposal as the current scope example; confirm commercial status separately before representing agreement. This review changes no client terms.

A future case study should explain starting problem, agreed change, what was delivered, staff adoption and measured results. Establish a baseline and comparable review period. Revenue growth can also reflect seasonality, advertising and stock availability. Saved staff time is released capacity until its productive use is observed.

Source files reviewed: clients/opes-tfs/client-proposal-ope.md; The-Frame-Shop/docs/proposal-for-ope.md; clients/opes-tfs/README.md; discovery-brief.md; services-and-pricing.md. Older price comparisons and return claims were not independently validated and should not become public proof.

POSITIONING NOTE 07

Make the full offer easy to buy

Organize services into four areas a business owner can recognize. Treat strategy, implementation and team adoption as the method across all four. AI can contribute within each area; it does not need to become a separate compulsory purchase.

Service area	Client-facing explanation	Examples within a defined scope
Customer experience and commerce	Help customers discover, choose and buy from you	Websites, shops, booking, payments, enquiry handling and customer support
Business systems and operations	Connect the information and work your team relies on	Customer records, admin tools, approvals, integrations and workflow automation
Data and business insight	Make performance easier to understand and act on	Data cleanup, reporting, dashboards and decision support
Digital products and new services	Turn a business idea into something people can use	Product discovery, prototypes, portals and custom applications

These are capability groups, not promises that every technology or industry is supported. Aksen should describe the part it can deliver, identify any partners needed and agree boundaries for each engagement. Broader organizational restructuring or specialist enterprise migrations require their own expertise and scope.

A practical engagement sequence: understand the business and its goal; prioritize the opportunity; design and build or configure the solution; help the team adopt it; review performance and improve where there is continuing value.

Offer a focused implementation when the need is already clear. Use a discovery engagement when the business needs diagnosis or a roadmap. Offer continuing support or improvement when there is a defined ongoing responsibility. A software subscription pays for access; a managed service pays for operating work. Explain them separately even when sold together.

Avoid turning "full transformation" into a vague all-inclusive package. For TFS, an agreed commerce and operations scope can form a coherent first engagement. Another business may begin with a booking system or a reporting problem. Aksen earns a wider relationship through delivery.

AI as a multiplier in plain language: AI helps people use information, prepare work and serve customers with less repeated effort. Its contribution depends on accurate records, reliable systems and clear business responsibilities. Payment confirmation, calculations and permissions should follow verified data and explicit rules. Commercial exceptions remain with the responsible person.

This service structure and delivery method are recommendations derived from the research and TFS scope. No new delivery capacity, service guarantee or price is asserted.

POSITIONING NOTE 08

Build products under Aksen Labs

The parent company owns the mission, trust and client relationship. A product should own a defined job for a defined customer. This allows several products over time while keeping Aksen Labs understandable.

Layer	What it means	How to describe it
Aksen Labs	The digital transformation agency	Business outcomes, capabilities, approach and evidence
Client engagement	A scoped implementation for a particular business	The Frame Shop commerce and operations proposal
Internal reusable component	Code, templates or tools that help Aksen deliver	Internal capability; no standalone sales claim
Named product	A repeatable offering a customer can buy and use	A specific product name followed by by Aksen Labs

Candidate product themes include commerce operations for a repeated retail need, a customer-service workspace or industry-specific intake. These are hypotheses, not launch announcements. Existing admin screens, agent demonstrations and client code do not automatically establish a standalone product.

Recommended product gate: test whether several independent customers share substantially the same problem and core workflow; establish willingness to pay; measure setup and support effort; define onboarding and ownership; verify a reliable product journey. Three comparable paid implementations can be a useful internal learning target, not a universal threshold or market proof.

Check the case for configuring existing software before building a competing product. Aksen's advantage may lie in industry fit, connected workflows, adoption support or local operating knowledge. A larger feature list by itself is a weak reason to build.

For the website now, service navigation should carry the main agency story. Place agent examples under relevant services or demonstrations. Add a Products destination when there is a real offering with a clear buyer, scope and next step. If showing experiments earlier, explicitly call them experiments.

Arkesel demonstrates the product naming pattern, and CWG/Fifthlab demonstrates services alongside software. Aksen should borrow that clarity while choosing its own product scope from client evidence. No partnership, resale authorization or technical integration with those businesses is implied.

Sources: [Arkesel KOVA IQ](#) and [CWG Fifthlab](#), undated, checked 7 September 2026. Product recommendations are strategic inference.

POSITIONING NOTE 09

Recommended messaging and website journey

Hero descriptor: Digital transformation for African businesses

Hero headline: Technology that helps your business grow.

Hero supporting copy: Aksen Labs helps you improve how your business sells, serves customers and gets work done. We build websites, business systems and digital products, connect your tools, and use AI to help your team do more.

Primary action: Discuss your business

Secondary action: Explore our services

Short company bio: Aksen Labs is a Ghana-based digital transformation agency helping African businesses grow through technology. We bring together digital experiences, business systems and practical AI, from strategy and implementation to team adoption.

Founder explanation: We look at what a business is trying to achieve and where its current setup is getting in the way. Then we design and implement the right digital solution. That could connect its website, payments and customer records, improve its internal operations, or become a new digital product. AI helps us make those systems and the people using them more effective.

The opening headline should stay stable as visitors explore examples. Use the next section to show business journeys: retail discovery through payment and fulfilment; a service enquiry through quotation and delivery; management records through decisions. This gives visitors a picture of the whole engagement.

Recommended page sequence: company promise and category; recognizable business opportunities; four service areas; approach; honest project examples; the role of AI; about Aksen and its African mission; contact. Products can join the sequence when available.

Recommended navigation: Services, Approach, Work, About, Insights. Use Work only with available material clearly labeled by status; until then, Examples is more precise. Add Products when there is something independently purchasable. Navigation items need working destinations before release.

The contact journey should accept both problems and ambitions. Start with "What would you like your business to do better?" Offer choices covering online sales, customer service, internal operations, business visibility and a new digital product, with room for an uncertain or unlisted need. Capture country for scoping without using it to exclude prospects automatically.

This is ready-to-use draft copy. It needs buyer comprehension testing and a coordinated implementation across pages, metadata, guide prompts and fallbacks. It has not been deployed by this research task.

POSITIONING NOTE 10

What to do next and what remains uncertain

First, adopt the positioning source. Use the accompanying messaging document as the current reference for Aksen's identity and geography. Keep past strategy files as history and apply their useful delivery discipline without retaining the superseded workflow-only category.

Next, update the complete public journey. Implement the hero and metadata together with navigation, service descriptions, opportunity intake and the Aksen Guide. A broad headline leading into an agent-only recommendation flow would preserve the existing confusion. Use the file-specific change map in the messaging document.

Then, validate with actual buyers. As a practical first test, speak with five reachable Ghanaian business owners and five Nigerian owners, including TFS only if appropriate and welcomed. This is a proposed qualitative sample, not a statistically representative survey. Show the message briefly, ask what Aksen does and what they would approach it for, and record their own words before explaining.

Question to resolve	Evidence to collect	Decision it informs
Do buyers understand the category?	Unaided descriptions of Aksen	Whether the supporting copy is specific enough
Which problems create action?	Recent examples, current costs and urgency	The next focused offer or campaign
Can Aksen deliver profitably?	Scoping, build, rework and support hours	Scope, price and concurrent workload
Is a pattern reusable?	Similar needs across independent paid projects	Service template or product investment
Does a market justify more attention?	Qualified conversations, paid conversion and delivery friction	Where to concentrate acquisition

Do not require Ghana to be "finished" before accepting a viable Nigerian project. Equally, do not scatter prospecting effort across many countries without learning. Choose a manageable set of opportunities, record why they qualify and review what their economics and delivery teach you.

Research limitations: vendor websites describe positioning and advertised features; none of their outcomes was independently audited here. Global AI survey findings are observational and not Ghana/Nigeria SME forecasts. Local structural studies are older and do not establish present willingness to pay. TFS files do not confirm commercial acceptance or delivery. Aksen capacity, margins and recurring product demand remain to be measured.

The research stopped after global and African structures converged, the Arkesel identity was verified and the important local contradictions were bounded. More generic competitor searches are unlikely to settle buyer comprehension or demand. Those questions now require client conversations and delivery evidence.